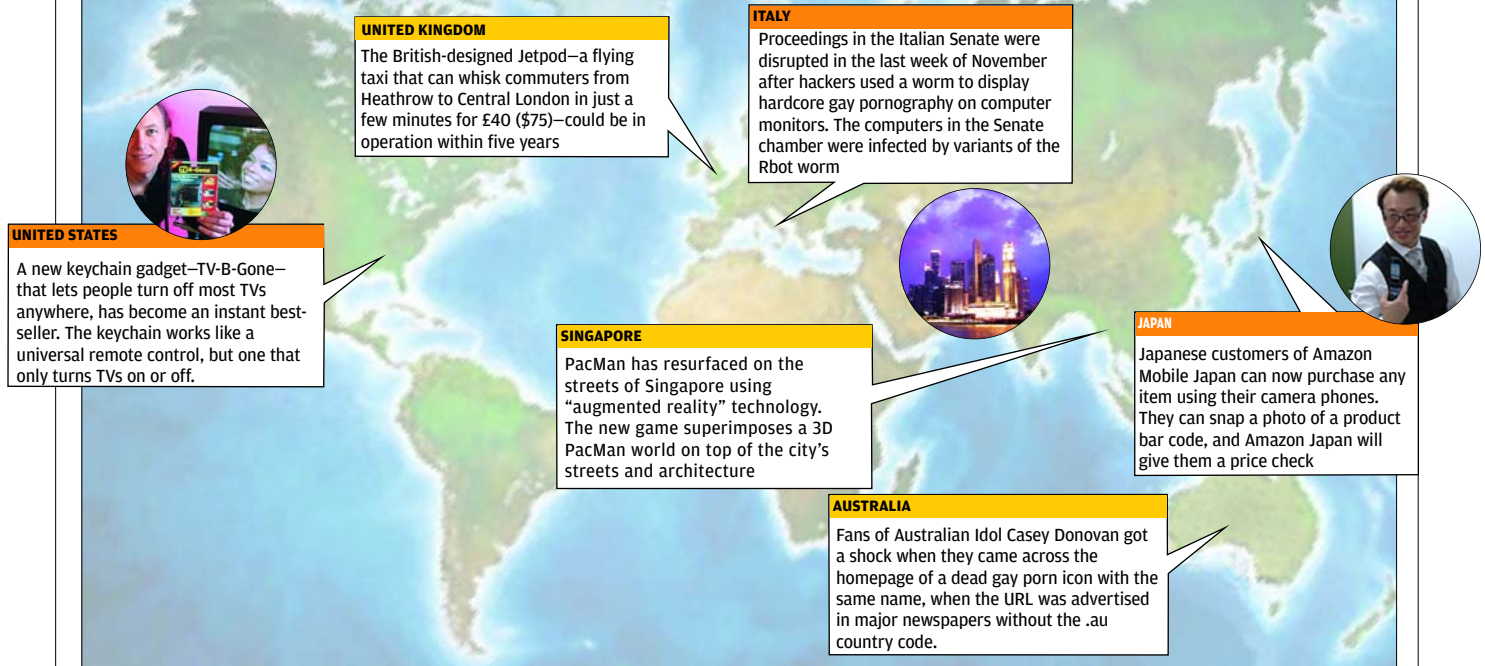


 The Digital World

A Round-up of Technology News from Across the Globe



National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM) President Kiran Karnik’s favourite anecdote these days is the one about how washing machines are being used in some parts of Punjab—*dhabhas* use them to mass-produce *lassi*! “If there is innovation happening anywhere, it’s in our country,” proclaims Karnik.

Reinforcing their commitment to “invest in innovation,” NASSCOM recently turned its attention to the Small and Medium Enterprises (SME) segment in India, which they estimate will generate nearly 50-60 per cent of IT revenues by the year 2008.

As part of the activities organised by the SME Forum, NASSCOM conducted the “Spot the Star” event across the country to identify SMEs companies that had the potential to make it big. Shortlisted companies made presentations to a panel of experts who in turn, gave their feedback. The “IT Innovation in India: Showcasing Emerging Companies” event

conducted in New Delhi, Mumbai and Bangalore identified the top six innovators for 2004:

Srishti Software (www.srishtisoft.com)—A Bangalore-based Knowledge Management, Application Integration, Open Source and e-Business Consulting solutions provider.

Liquid Krystal India (www.liquidkrystal.com)—Liquid Krystal’s CodeSaw provides a digital workspace where IT learning is a hands-on experience.

PACE Soft Silicon (www.pace-softsilicon.com)—Develops value-added multimedia products, applications and architectures for packet-based wireless applications.

Compulink Systems’ (www.compulink.co.in) Whizible ProjectByNet is an enterprise-wide Services Execution Management (SEM) solution that helps service-centric organisations automate their key business processes effectively.

Whizlabs Software (<http://www.whizlabs.com>)—This Delhi-based company

 Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Hardware Information and Reviews

tomshardware.com**Tom’s Hardware Guide**

This site is an almost comprehensive site for everything hardware—for those of us who aren’t techy enough, and need things explained to us. From motherboards and RAM to networking and games, from graphic cards to peripherals, from articles to how-tos, you’ll find it all here

www.anandtech.com**AnandTech**

If you’re about to buy something—a technological gadget, that is—this is the place to go. Just like in Tom’s Hardware, there are reviews, insider stories, news and views, and so on, about almost everything—from CPUs to chipsets, Linux to digital cameras, and on and on and on.

www.techreport.com**The Tech Report**

This site is similar to the two above, except that it focuses more on insider news, stories and discussions. If you want to stay up to date with the state of the art of personal computing technology, this is the site for you. Nothing is left out—be it printers, processors, P2P networks, or what have you.